

COGNITIVE BEHAVIORAL THERAPY (CBT) – SESSION 12

New Case: Rohan (26 y/o) – Contamination OCD + Checking

Highly Detailed – Realistic Style

SESSION INFORMATION

Client:	Rohan (26 years, Male, Software Engineer, Bangalore)	Therapist:	Dr. A.
Session #:	12 of 18–20	Focus:	Continuing ERP + Reviewing Progress

PRE-SESSION THERAPIST NOTES

Client arrived looking more confident and engaged than previous sessions. He practiced the public surface exposure at home 1 time with good habituation. He reported that anxiety is decreasing faster with repeated practice and that he is delaying other compulsions more consistently. He continues to use labeling effectively. Today's plan: Review home ERP practice in detail, continue ERP with the next hierarchy item if appropriate, reinforce progress and coping skills, and begin discussing relapse prevention / maintenance planning. Maintain supportive and encouraging approach.

SESSION START – HOMEWORK REVIEW

Therapist: Good morning, Rohan. How has your week been? I'm curious to hear how the public surface exposure practice at home went.

Client: (speaking with more confidence) It went quite well. I practiced it one time. Anxiety went up to around 70–75 and took about 25–28 minutes to come down significantly. I was able to resist washing for over 30 minutes. It was hard at first, but the anxiety came down gradually. I also noticed that on days when I used labeling quickly, other contamination urges felt more manageable too. I still washed more than I ideally want to, but I'm delaying significantly more often now.

Therapist: That's excellent continued progress. You're clearly experiencing faster habituation with repeated practice — the anxiety is rising less and coming down quicker, even with higher-level exposures. You're also generalizing the labeling skill effectively. How are you feeling about these changes?

Client: I feel more hopeful and a bit proud. Each practice is getting a bit easier, and I'm seeing that I can handle more than I thought. I'm still nervous about some of the higher items on the list, but I think I can keep going.

CONTINUING ERP – NEXT HIERARCHY ITEM / REVIEW

Therapist: Since you're making consistent progress and we're approaching the higher end of your hierarchy, I'd like to suggest we review where we are and decide together on the next step. Your hierarchy had one more challenging item: touching a public surface (like a metro rail) and resisting washing for 30+ minutes — which you already practiced successfully in session last time. How do you feel about where we are now?

Client: I think I've made good progress. The exposures are getting easier, and I'm delaying more in daily life too. I still feel nervous about some real-life situations, but I feel much more capable than when we started.

Therapist: That's wonderful to hear. It sounds like you've built significant tolerance and confidence. As we continue, we can keep practicing the higher items and also begin thinking about how to maintain these gains after therapy ends. Would it be okay if we started discussing relapse prevention and maintenance planning alongside continuing ERP?

Client: Yes, I think that would be helpful. I want to make sure I can keep this progress going even after we finish therapy.

BEGINNING RELAPSE PREVENTION / MAINTENANCE PLANNING

Therapist: As we move forward, it's important to plan how you'll maintain these gains after therapy ends. One key part is identifying your ****Early Warning Signs**** — signals that OCD might be returning or getting stronger. Another is having a clear ****Action Plan**** for what to do if symptoms increase. We can start building this together over the next few sessions. How does that sound?

Client: It sounds good. I want to make sure I have a plan so I don't go back to how things were before.

Therapist: Perfect. We'll continue ERP practice while also building your maintenance plan. This way, you'll feel equipped both to keep progressing and to handle any future difficulties.

HOMEWORK ASSIGNMENT

Therapist: For this week:

1. Continue practicing the public surface exposure at home (1 time)
2. Continue practicing previous hierarchy items as needed
3. Continue labeling and monitoring
4. Start thinking about your Early Warning Signs (e.g., increased washing, stronger urges, more checking, more avoidance) — we'll discuss this next session

Client: I'll try the public surface one and also think about my warning signs. I want to make sure I can maintain this progress.

Therapist: Excellent. We'll review everything next session.

SESSION SUMMARY & FEEDBACK

Therapist: Today we reviewed your strong progress at home, discussed where we are in the hierarchy, and began thinking about relapse prevention and maintenance planning. How are you feeling about today's session?

Client: I feel good. I'm proud of how far I've come, and I like that we're starting to think about how to keep this progress going after therapy ends. I'm still nervous about some things, but I feel much more capable now.

Therapist: That's wonderful to hear. Any questions before we finish?

Client: Not really.

POST-SESSION THERAPIST NOTES

- Client showed continued strong progress in ERP. Successfully completed higher-level exposures with excellent habituation.
- Client reported increased confidence and generalization of coping skills.
- Motivation and engagement remain high. Client expressed desire to maintain gains post-therapy.
- Began introducing relapse prevention / maintenance planning concepts.
- Next session: Review home ERP practice, continue ERP if needed, deepen relapse prevention planning (Early Warning Signs + Action Plan), reinforce coping skills and self-compassion.

Disclaimer: This is a completely fictional but realistic simulation created solely for educational and AI training purposes. It does not represent any real person or therapy.